

MD & CEO's Office Intern

At AU Small Finance Bank, Jaipur

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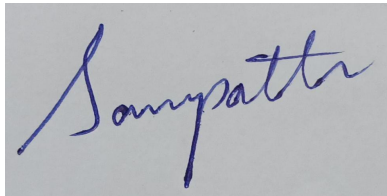
Declaration

I, Malla Sampath Narayana, hereby declare that the report titled “MD & CEO’s Office Intern” is an original work carried out solely by me during my internship at AU Small Finance Bank, Jaipur, from 01st June 2026 to 01st September 2026.

I affirm that all the work presented in this report is my own, and any assistance or contributions from others have been duly acknowledged. The results and findings are based entirely on my efforts, and no part of this work has been copied or reproduced from any other source, except where due reference has been made.

Furthermore, this report has not been submitted, in whole or in part, for the award of any degree, diploma, or certification at any other institution.

Signature:

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Sampath Narayana", is displayed within a rectangular frame.

Date: 04th September 2026

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview of the Internship

This internship was carried out at AU Small Finance Bank Limited, within the Office of the Managing Director & CEO, as part of a newly formed team called the Centre of Excellence (CoE). The CoE was set up to identify, prioritise and scale high-impact artificial intelligence and transformation initiatives across the Bank, working alongside business teams, technology specialists and external partners.

Being positioned inside the MD & CEO's office meant there was no narrow, fixed job description. The role was deliberately broad, and the work changed with the priorities of senior management on any given day. This gave me an unusually close view of how decisions are made at the top of a large regulated institution: how a problem is first framed, how it is broken down, how stakeholders across functions are aligned, and how a decision finally translates into execution on the ground.

The internship combined three kinds of exposure that rarely come together in a single role:

1. **Strategic exposure:** sitting in discussions with the Deputy CEO, COO, CIO and CFO, and observing how competing priorities, cost, risk and customer impact are weighed against each other.
2. **Analytical exposure:** extensive hands-on work with large datasets in Excel and Advanced Excel, including data preparation for a workforce-level policy rollout.
3. **Technology exposure:** practical understanding of Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), agentic AI platforms, and how AI use cases are evaluated for feasibility and cost reduction before they are taken up for build.

The period coincided with a significant phase in the Bank's technology journey, as AU SFB moved towards becoming an AI-native bank, which meant the work was live, visible and directly tied to organisational outcomes rather than being simulated or academic.

1.2 Tasks during the Internship

The following tasks were undertaken over the course of the internship:

1. **Identification of AI use cases across HR, Legal and Customer Service**
Conducted structured discussions with stakeholders across the HR, Legal and Customer Service functions to map processes that were manual, repetitive and high in volume, and therefore suitable candidates for AI-led automation. Customer Service emerged as

the highest-priority area. In the last financial year the Bank handled approximately **75,00,000 QRCs (Queries, Requests and Complaints)** – roughly **27,00,000 queries, 47,00,000 requests and 1,00,000 complaints**, arriving through voice, email and complaint channels.

The proposed solution was a bot/platform layer built on top of the existing Core Banking System (CBS) that could auto-fetch customer information and respond without manual intervention. For example, if a customer emails asking for their account balance or the prevailing FD rates, the system retrieves the data and issues a response automatically, with the same capability extended to the voice bot. Two customer scenarios were defined:

- **ETB (Existing to Bank):** if the query originates from a registered email ID or mobile number, customer details are fetched directly after verification.
- **NTB (New to Bank):** if the sender is unregistered, the customer is prompted to provide a registered email ID or mobile number before servicing.

2. Contribution to the AI chapter of the Annual Report Reviewed the proposed technology and AI section for the Bank’s Integrated Annual Report (“Scaling with Intelligence – Building an AI-Native Bank”) and suggested four to five changes to strengthen the narrative and accuracy of the piece. The suggested revisions were accepted and carried into the published Annual Report.

3. Data preparation for the WFH/Hybrid rollout for 2,000+ employees Prepared and validated the employee dataset required to identify approximately 2,000 employees eligible for Work From Home / Hybrid working out of a base of over 10,000 employees. The dataset was built after multiple rounds of consultation with stakeholders across functions to agree on eligibility criteria. I currently act as the main point of contact (POC) for this project. AU SFB was among the earlier adopters of a structured hybrid model at this scale in the sector.

4. Vendor finalisation for the workforce productivity tracking tool Evaluated more than ten vendors offering employee productivity and activity tracking solutions to be deployed on the systems of employees moving to WFH/Hybrid mode. Participated in demos, comparison of features, pricing and data-privacy posture, and shortlisted the final vendor, **we360.ai**.

5. Stakeholder coordination with senior management Coordinated across departments and with senior management professionals including the Deputy CEO, COO, CIO and CFO for approvals, inputs, data validation and project updates.

6. LEA (Law Enforcement Agency) Bot project Worked as part of the internal team alongside the implementation vendor on a new solution to automate the handling

of communication received from law enforcement and government agencies. Previously, incoming mails were read and manually routed to the relevant team. The bot analyses the incoming mail, identifies the information being requested, auto-fetches the relevant data from internal systems and prepares a draft response. Final review and dispatch remain with a human-in-the-loop, preserving accountability on a sensitive, compliance-heavy process.

7. Categorisation of 1,000+ documents on Intellect (Purple Fabric) Categorised and uploaded over 1,000 SOPs, circulars and amendments onto the Intellect (Purple Fabric) platform, applying **page-wise chunking for RAG** so that the content could be accurately retrieved by the Bank's internal knowledge assistants. This directly expanded the Bank's institutional knowledge base and improved the quality of AI-generated answers to internal policy questions.

8. Preparation of presentations for senior management Built decks used in leadership reviews and internal forums, converting raw data, meeting outcomes and project status into concise, decision-ready material.

9. Design of a structured performance appraisal quantification framework Currently working on a more structured and streamlined method to quantify appraisals and hikes. Under the existing system, a manager assigns a rating on a scale of 1 to 5, which does not accurately capture the actual contribution of an employee. The objective is to introduce measurable, role-relevant parameters so that the outcome is more objective and defensible.

1.3 Overview of the Company

AU Small Finance Bank Limited is India's largest small finance bank, headquartered in Jaipur, Rajasthan.

Founding and history The organisation began in 1996 as an asset finance NBFC named 'AU Financiers', founded by Mr. Sanjay Agarwal. It converted into a scheduled commercial small finance bank in April 2017 after receiving a licence from the Reserve Bank of India. AU SFB subsequently became the first small finance bank to receive in-principle approval from the RBI to transition into a universal bank.

Scale and reach The Bank operates close to 2,790 touchpoints across 25 states and 4 union territories, serving over 1.1 crore customers, with a workforce of more than 10,000 employees.

Core offerings and business model AU SFB focuses on retail financial services, vehicle finance, MSME loans and housing finance, with a strong orientation towards underserved and unbanked segments. Its product suite includes savings and current accounts, fixed

deposits, credit cards (including Zenith+), personal, car and home loans, along with investment and insurance products. The Bank is listed on both the National Stock Exchange (NSE) and the Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE).

Technology posture Technology at AU SFB has historically been treated as a means to scale with discipline rather than as an end in itself. The Bank has built a centralised data lake integrating more than 50 source systems as a single source of truth, migrated origination processes onto Salesforce with FICO as the business-rules engine, and completed the core banking system migration of erstwhile Fincare SFB onto a single unified platform. During the year it launched an enterprise-wide Agentic AI platform built on Dailoqa and Intellect, supporting both internal and customer-facing use cases, and established an AI Centre of Excellence to prioritise and scale high-impact use cases. The Bank’s technology agenda is organised under a **Run – Build – Transform** framework, covering reliable operations, differentiated customer experiences, and AI, data intelligence and cyber resilience respectively.

2. PRELIMINARIES

2.1 Role and Responsibilities

The role was that of an intern attached to the Office of the MD & CEO under the Centre of Excellence. The core responsibilities were:

- **Use-case discovery:** engage with business functions to identify processes suitable for AI intervention, with an emphasis on cost reduction and turnaround-time improvement.
- **Stakeholder management:** act as a coordination point between business departments, the technology team, external vendors and senior management.
- **Data preparation and analysis:** build, clean, validate and analyse large employee and operational datasets using Excel and Advanced Excel.
- **Vendor evaluation:** assess vendor offerings against functional, commercial and data-protection criteria and support the selection decision.
- **Documentation and knowledge management:** structure internal documentation for ingestion into the Bank’s RAG-based knowledge platform.
- **Communication:** prepare presentations, notes and summaries for senior management consumption.
- **Project ownership:** act as the primary POC for the WFH/Hybrid rollout and main-

tain continuity across its moving parts.

Because the office had no fixed job description, the responsibilities were expected to shift daily. A single week could include vendor negotiation, dataset preparation, deck-building and attending an industry conference with senior leadership.

2.2 Task Executed

#	Task	Nature of Work	Output
1	AI use-case identification (HR, Legal, Customer Service)	Stakeholder interviews, process mapping, volume analysis	Prioritised use-case list; ETB/NTB servicing bot concept on top of CBS
2	Annual Report AI chapter	Content review and editorial input	4–5 suggested changes accepted and published
3	WFH/Hybrid rollout	Data preparation, eligibility criteria, coordination	Validated dataset of 2,000+ employees from a 10,000+ base
4	Productivity tracking tool	Vendor evaluation and shortlisting	we360.ai selected from 10+ vendors
5	Senior management coordination	Meetings, follow-ups, approvals	Alignment across Deputy CEO, COO, CIO, CFO
6	LEA Bot	Requirement definition with vendor, workflow design	Automated mail analysis, data retrieval and draft generation with human-in-the-loop
7	Knowledge base expansion	Document categorisation, page-wise chunking for RAG	1,000+ SOPs and amendments uploaded to Intellect (Purple Fabric)
8	Management reporting	Presentation design and data storytelling	Decks for leadership reviews
9	Appraisal framework	Framework design, parameter definition	Structured model to replace subjective 1–5 rating (in progress)

3. PROJECT METHODOLOGY

3.1 Project Execution Details

A. AI Use-Case Identification and the Customer Service Bot

The approach followed a discovery-to-design sequence:

1. **Stakeholder mapping** — identify process owners in HR, Legal and Customer Service.
2. **Process walkthroughs** — document existing workflows end to end, capturing where human effort was spent and where delays originated.
3. **Volume quantification** — size each process. Customer Service was prioritised because of the sheer volume of ~ 75 lakh QRCs annually, where even partial automation yields material cost savings.
4. **Segmentation of intent** — classify incoming QRCs into repetitive, data-retrieval-led queries (balance enquiries, FD rates, statement requests) versus judgement-led cases requiring human handling.
5. **Solution design** — define a bot layer sitting above the CBS that authenticates the customer, retrieves the required field from core systems, and responds through the same channel the customer used. Branching logic was defined for ETB and NTB customers to keep authentication compliant.
6. **Feasibility validation** — check the design against data availability, integration effort and regulatory constraints with the technology team.

B. WFH/Hybrid Rollout for 2,000+ Employees

1. Defined eligibility criteria jointly with HR and business heads, based on role type, function criticality and system access requirements.
2. Extracted and consolidated employee data from source systems into a working master file.
3. Cleaned and standardised the dataset, resolving duplicates, inconsistent role tagging and incomplete records using Advanced Excel functions.
4. Applied eligibility filters to arrive at the final population of approximately 2,000 employees from a base of over 10,000.

5. Circulated the working list to stakeholders for validation and incorporated their corrections through multiple iterations.
6. Ran the vendor evaluation in parallel so that the monitoring tool was ready at the point of rollout.
7. Continued as POC for coordination, exception handling and status reporting.

C. Vendor Finalisation (we360.ai)

Over ten vendors were evaluated. The comparison covered functional coverage, ease of deployment across a large device base, reporting and dashboard quality, data privacy and security posture, integration with existing HR systems, support model, and commercial terms. Shortlisted vendors were taken through demos with the relevant stakeholders, and the findings were consolidated into a comparison sheet and presented for decision. we360.ai was finalized.

D. LEA Bot

1. Documented the existing manual process for handling communication from law enforcement agencies, including how mails were read, interpreted and routed.
2. Identified the bottleneck: manual reading and assignment created delay and inconsistency on time-sensitive, compliance-critical requests.
3. Worked with the vendor to define the bot's scope — parse the incoming mail, classify the request type, extract the specific data points being sought, retrieve them from internal systems, and assemble a draft response.
4. Insisted on human-in-the-loop as a design principle: the draft is reviewed and released by an authorised officer, never dispatched autonomously. This preserved accountability and aligned with the Bank's stated position that human judgement remains central to critical decisions.

E. Knowledge Base Expansion on Intellect (Purple Fabric)

1. Collected SOPs, circulars and amendments spread across the organisation.
2. Defined a categorisation taxonomy so documents could be grouped meaningfully by function and process.
3. Applied **page-wise chunking** while ingesting documents, so that retrieval returns a tightly scoped passage rather than an entire document. This materially improves the precision of RAG-based answers and reduces hallucination risk.

4. Uploaded and tagged over 1,000 documents onto the platform.
5. Spot-checked retrieval quality by querying the platform and verifying that responses mapped back to the correct source page.

F. Appraisal Quantification Framework (ongoing)

1. Studied the limitations of the existing 1–5 manager-assigned rating, particularly its subjectivity and its weak linkage to actual output.
2. Began identifying measurable, role-specific parameters that could support the rating.
3. Working towards a structured model that makes the appraisal and hike decision more transparent and defensible.

3.2 Challenges Faced and Solutions

Challenge	How it was addressed
No fixed job description or predictable schedule. Priorities shifted daily; one day was spent entirely in meetings from 9 a.m. to 9 p.m., another on vendor finalisation, another on decks or conferences.	Adopted a strict daily prioritisation habit and maintained a running tracker of open items across all projects so that nothing was dropped when attention shifted. Learned to context-switch quickly without losing thread continuity.
Working with stakeholders far more senior and experienced. Interacting with the Deputy CEO, COO, CIO and CFO required a very different standard of preparation.	Prepared thoroughly before every interaction, kept communication short and data-backed, and led with the recommendation rather than the process. Learned to anticipate the questions that would be asked.
Fragmented and inconsistent employee data across source systems while preparing the WFH/Hybrid list.	Built a standardised master file, used Advanced Excel to resolve duplicates and inconsistencies, and ran multiple validation cycles with function owners rather than relying on a single extract.
Conflicting eligibility views across departments for the hybrid rollout.	Facilitated joint discussions to agree on criteria upfront, so that the final list was the outcome of an agreed rule rather than a negotiation on individual names.
Vendor comparison across 10+ options with differing feature sets and pricing structures.	Built a common evaluation matrix with weighted criteria so that vendors could be compared on a like-for-like basis instead of on demo quality.
Retrieval accuracy in the RAG knowledge base. Uploading whole documents produced imprecise answers.	Moved to page-wise chunking and a clear categorisation taxonomy, which narrowed retrieval scope and improved answer relevance.
Sensitivity of the LEA use case, where an incorrect automated response carries regulatory consequence.	Scoped the bot to draft-generation only, with mandatory human review and approval before dispatch.
Ambiguity — problems without clean answers. Several questions had no readily available solution.	Learned that the approach matters as much as the answer: structure the problem, isolate what is known, test assumptions, and move forward with the best available reasoning rather than waiting for certainty.

4. RESULTS

4.1 Key Achievements

- **Identified and structured AI use cases across three major functions** — HR, Legal, and Customer Service — with the Customer Service opportunity sized at approximately 75 lakh annual QRCs (27 lakh queries, 47 lakh requests and 1 lakh complaints), establishing a clear case for automation-led cost reduction.
- **Designed the concept for a CBS-layered servicing bot** with defined ETB and NTB authentication flows, capable of auto-fetching customer information and responding across email and voice channels.
- **Contributed to the Bank’s published Integrated Annual Report.** Four to five suggested changes to the AI and technology chapter were accepted and appear in the final published document.
- **Enabled the WFH/Hybrid rollout for 2,000+ employees** from a base of over 10,000 by preparing and validating the underlying dataset, and continuing to serve as the main POC for the project. AU SFB was among the earlier adopters of a structured hybrid model at this scale in the industry.
- **Finalised the workforce monitoring vendor (we360.ai)** after evaluating more than ten vendors against a structured comparison framework.
- **Contributed to the LEA Bot build**, converting a fully manual mail-triage and response process into an automated analyse-retrieve-draft workflow with human-in-the-loop control.
- **Expanded the Bank’s internal knowledge base by 1,000+ documents** on Intellect (Purple Fabric) using page-wise chunking for RAG, improving retrieval precision for internal AI assistants.
- **Delivered presentations used in senior management forums**, translating raw data and project status into decision-ready material.
- **Initiated the design of a structured appraisal quantification framework** intended to replace a subjective 1–5 rating with measurable parameters.

5. CONCLUSION

5.1 Learnings from the Internship

The most valuable learning was seeing how decisions are actually made at the top of a large, regulated organisation. Discussions at that level are rarely about picking the obvious option; they are about dissecting the problem, testing assumptions, weighing cost against risk and customer impact, and then committing. Being present in those rooms taught me more about business judgement than any single project did.

Specific learnings include:

- **Problem framing precedes problem solving.** A well-framed problem often makes the solution obvious. Much of the CoE's value came from the framing.
- **Volume is the strongest argument for automation.** The case for the Customer Service bot was made not by describing the technology but by quantifying 75 lakh annual interactions.
- **AI in banking is a governance question as much as a technology question.** The human-in-the-loop design on the LEA bot was not a limitation; it was what made the solution acceptable.
- **RAG quality depends on ingestion discipline.** Page-wise chunking and clean categorisation had more impact on answer quality than any downstream tuning.
- **Excel remains indispensable.** It was my go-to tool throughout, and a large share of the analytical work ran through Excel and Advanced Excel.
- **We may not always find the answer, but how we approach the problem is what matters.** This was the single most repeated lesson of the internship.

5.2 Personal Growth

The internship was a period of disciplined growth. Working in the MD & CEO's office with no fixed job description meant that adaptability was not optional. Days varied enormously: one day was spent in meetings continuously from 9 a.m. to 9 p.m.; another on finalising vendors for a new project; another on building presentations; another attending an industry conference alongside senior management.

The most noticeable changes in myself were:

- **Professional maturity.** Being in rooms with people twice my age and several times

my experience raised my own standard of preparation and communication.

- **Ownership.** Holding POC responsibility for a 2,000+ employee rollout meant being accountable for follow-through, not just for output.
- **Communication.** I learned to compress complex work into short, senior-appropriate summaries and decks.
- **Comfort with ambiguity.** I became more willing to move forward on incomplete information with a defensible approach, rather than stalling for certainty.
- **Structured thinking.** Repeated exposure to how leadership breaks down problems reshaped how I approach my own.

5.3 Career Aspirations

This experience has clarified the direction I want to pursue. I want to build a career at the intersection of **business strategy, data and applied artificial intelligence**, in roles where the work is about identifying where technology creates measurable value rather than implementing technology for its own sake.

In the near term, I intend to strengthen my technical depth in data analytics, RAG and agentic AI systems, alongside the analytical toolkit I have built in Excel and Advanced Excel, while continuing to develop the stakeholder management and structured-communication skills this internship demanded.

In the longer term, I aspire to work in strategy, transformation or AI-enablement roles within financial services or consulting, and eventually to lead a function similar to the Centre of Excellence — a team that sits close to leadership, identifies high-impact opportunities across the organisation, and converts them into working solutions. This internship confirmed both that this kind of work exists and that it is the kind of work I want to do.